



Google+ doesn't care

All it wants is your biographical information
<http://tcn.ch/Av8n4c>

Nokia Money shuts down

Nokia's recently launched Nokia Money service will soon be discontinued, surprising many as mobile payments are growing rapidly <http://digit.in/GEIK7K>

Over 100 government web sites hacked in 3 months: Sachin Pilot

As many as 112 government websites, including those of the Planning Commission, the Finance Ministry and various state government agencies were hit by cyber attacks during a three-month period ending February 2012, revealed Minister of State for Communications and IT, Sachin Pilot in the Lok Sabha.

The minister further revealed that Bharat Sanchar Nigam Ltd (BSNL) web site was hacked on December 4, 2011 by a hacker group called 'H4tr!ck'. The web sites of Finance, Health, Human Resource Development ministries and Planning Commission also suffered the cyber attacks. A number of state government web sites, including those of Andhra Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, Kerala,

Odisha, Uttar Pradesh, Sikkim, Manipur, Madhya Pradesh, Rajasthan, Maharashtra and Gujarat came under attack.

Pilot also said that the Department of Information Technology and the National Informatics Centre (NIC) are working on upgrading their skills to handle threats from cyber attackers, as well as their firewalls and filters. **d**

Microsoft accuses Google of sidestepping privacy in IE

Microsoft jumped into the Google "Safari tracking" controversy by accusing the search giant of doing the same thing with its Internet Explorer browser.

Dean Hachamovitch, corporate vice president of Internet Explorer, said, "When the IE team heard that Google had bypassed user privacy settings on Safari, we asked ourselves a simple question: is Google circumventing the privacy preferences of Internet Explorer users too? We've discovered the answer is yes: Google is employing similar methods to get around the default privacy protections in IE and track IE users with cookies."

Microsoft said that IE users can avoid the tracking by using the Tracking Protection feature in IE9. In response, Rachel Whetstone, senior vice president of communications and policy at Google, said that Microsoft "omitted important information."

The P3P standard, Whetstone said, dated back to 2002 and it's "impractical to comply with Microsoft's request while providing modern web functionality. We've been open about our approach, as have many other web sites."

"Today the Microsoft policy is widely non-operational," Whetstone continued. "A 2010 research report indicated that over 11,000 web sites were not issuing valid P3P policies as requested by Microsoft." **d**

Govt. sites hit by cyber attacks during CWG

The Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO) – a government organisation that researches new technologies for defence and combat – has revealed that computer servers of the government departments were attacked nearly 200 times during the 2010 Commonwealth Games in Delhi.

Speaking of attacks during the CWG 2010, DRDO chief and scientific adviser to defence minister Dr V.K. Saraswat said that a strong team of experts helped DRDO thwart these hacking attempts.

Saraswat, further said that the DRDO would soon form a strong encryption group that will develop encryption techniques to keep the attackers at bay. The DRDO is also planning to develop indigenous servers, routers and operating systems in an attempt to effectively combat cyber attacks. **d**

Credit card details may have been leaked in Microsoft Store India attack

Microsoft is belatedly warning members of Microsoft Store India that their financial information such as credit card details, "may have been exposed" in the cyber-attack in the earlier part of February.

The attack took place on February 12, with the Evil Shadow team taking credit for defacing the site with a message, saying "unsafe systems will be baptized."

Soon after the attack, the Redmond giant had reassured Microsoft Store India members that only usernames, passwords and contact information had been potentially stolen. Members were advised to change their passwords on other properties, and were to have received



an email instructing them on how to reset their Microsoft Store password.

Microsoft Store India is still offline however, and according to recent reports, Microsoft has now mailed the same members, advising them to closely monitor for any unauthorised credit card activity, and warn the card provider about potential unauthorised use.

Microsoft has now created a hotline number 1-800-102-1100 for members to call for more information on how to deal with the issue. **d**